

Vocabulary

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Overview

- 1 Loans as a map of the past
- 2 Building words — Derivational Morphology
- 3 Meaning differences between languages
- 4 Some cultural key words

Outline

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Loanwords Are a Map of Contact

- Every borrowed word records a **contact**: trade, religion, conquest, fashion
- Old loans blend in; new ones still look **foreign**
- Peel back the layers to read a language's **history**

This week follows Goddard (2005, Chapter 3).

Four Kinds of Loan

Kind	Example	Comment
indigenized	<i>gift, root</i>	so old nobody notices
prestige	<i>crown, judge</i>	high status, like the rulers' language
cultural	<i>coffee, sushi</i>	a new thing arrives
calque	<i>sky-scraper</i>	translate the parts: German <i>Wolken-kratzer</i> French <i>gratte-ciel</i>

English: Layer upon Layer

When	From	Examples
800s–900s	Old Norse	<i>take, get, want, die, low</i>
from 1066	Norman French	<i>crown, judge, court, army</i>
from 1400s	Latin, Greek	<i>scientific, describe, bonus</i>
1500s on	the world	<i>canoe, tomato, coffee, tsunami</i>

- Norse was close to Old English, so its words are now invisible
- Latin was the language of learning; printing spread its words

The Farmer's Animal, the Lord's Dinner

on the farm (English)	on the table (French)
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*cow**beef**sheep**mutton*

After 1066, French was the language of the rulers and English that of the common people, giving a **dual vocabulary** for common and formal use

Borrowed Parts Become Productive

ex- ex-wife
-able readable googleable

Learned words came from Latin and Greek, often by way of French — and brought affixes that now attach to anything

Words Travel by Indirect Routes

Word	From	Via
<i>canoe, potato</i>	Taíno	Spanish
<i>tomato, chocolate</i>	Nahuatl	Spanish
<i>coffee</i>	Arabic	Turkish
<i>sushi, tsunami</i>	Japanese	—

These loans mark new foods, objects and practices

Loans Can Change the Sound System

Old English *leaf* [f] *leaves* [v]
 one phoneme /f/, two sounds

after French *fine* *vine*
 two phonemes: /f/ $\neq$ /v/

French loans such as *veal* and *vine* made /v/ a phoneme

Malay: Religion Brought Words

Sanskrit, Pali	<i>rasa</i>	feel, taste
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2nd c. BC on	<i>nama</i>	name
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	<i>guru</i>	teacher
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Arabic	<i>fikir</i>	think
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with Islam, 1200s on	<i>ilmu</i>	knowledge
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	<i>waktu</i>	time
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	<i>haram</i>	forbidden
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- Malay sits at the **crossroads** of India and China
- Indic loans are fully nativised; Arabic ones keep their fricatives and spellings like *kh*: *khabar* “news”

Malay: Trade and Empire Brought Words

Tamil	<i>kedai</i> “shop”, <i>katil</i> “bed”, <i>mangga</i> “mango”
Chinese	<i>teh</i> “tea”, <i>mi</i> “noodles”
Portuguese	<i>gereja</i> “church”, <i>garpu</i> “fork”, <i>almari</i> “cupboard”
Dutch	<i>senapang</i> “gun”, <i>pelakat</i> “placard”
English	<i>tiket</i> “ticket”, <i>kamera</i> “camera”

Regional trade first; European colonisers after the fall of Malacca in 1511

Different Colonisers, Different Loans

	Malaysia	Indonesia	
office	<i>ofis</i>	<i>kantor</i>	< Dutch <i>kantoor</i>
ticket	<i>tiket</i>	<i>karcis</i>	< Dutch <i>kaartjes</i>

Malay borrows from English (Britain), Indonesian from Dutch (the Netherlands)

Thai: Indic Words Are the Formal Register

	Native Thai	Indic
head	<i>hǔa</i>	<i>sǐisà'</i>
eye	<i>taa</i>	<i>phranêet</i>
dog	<i>mǎa</i>	<i>sunák</i>

- Burmese, Thai, Lao and Khmer took Sanskrit and Pali with Theravada Buddhism — and their scripts
- New words are often **calques** on Indic roots: *thoola².that¹* “television” [far.vision]
- European loans are rarer (though becoming common)

Chinese in Mainland Southeast Asia

Lao, from Chinese

toq2 table

ngen2 money

bòò1 not

- Over 1,000 years of contact: Lao, Thai and Vietnamese
- Numbers and **classifiers** especially
- Strongest in Vietnamese, down to basic nouns — and grammar too

Chinese in Korea and Japan

釈迦	<i>Shaka</i>	Buddha
鉢	<i>hachi</i>	bowl
馬	<i>uma</i>	horse

- Borrowing begins in the first millennium AD, with Buddhism: traditionally 552 (*Nihon shoki*; 538 in other sources), from Paekche (in Korea)
- Script, religion and social norms came too

Japanese: Who Brought Which Words

When	From	Examples
mid-1500s	Portuguese	<i>tempura</i>
Edo	Dutch	<i>kokku</i> “cook”, <i>garasu</i> “glass”
Meiji on	French	<i>atorie</i> “studio”, <i>ankēto</i> “survey”
Meiji on	English	<i>terebi</i> “TV”, <i>sararii</i> “salary”

Japan was closed to all Europeans but the Dutch until 1854, so French loans are Meiji or later

Japanese Loans Today: Borrow, Then Rebuild

loan	<i>yogapantsu</i>	yoga pants
	<i>beddo</i>	Western-style bed
clipped	<i>rimōto</i>	remote working
hybrid	<i>ichigo-ēdo</i>	strawberry + “-ade”
	<i>wan-man-kaa</i>	one-man (driver-only) bus

Technology, fashion and popular culture borrow most

Return Loans: 和製漢語 *wasei-kango*

Meiji Japan built new words from **Chinese** morphemes for Western ideas — and China, Korea and Vietnam borrowed them **back**

		Japanese	Mandarin	Vietnamese
科学/科学	science	<i>kagaku</i>	<i>kēxué</i>	<i>khoa học</i>
經濟/经济	economy	<i>keizai</i>	<i>jīngjì</i>	<i>kinh tế</i>
社会/社会	society	<i>shakai</i>	<i>shèhuì</i>	<i>xã hội</i>

Some are new coinages (哲学 *tetsugaku* “philosophy”, 電話 *denwa* “telephone”); others give old Chinese words a new sense (經濟 < 經世濟民 “govern the world, relieve the people”). So a Sino-Japanese word need not be a loan *from* Chinese.

Pseudo-Loans: Made at Home from Foreign Parts

		from
<i>sararīman</i>	office worker	<i>salary man</i>
<i>konsento</i>	power socket	<i>concentric plug</i>
<i>haendeupon</i>	mobile phone	<i>hand phone</i>
<i>apateu</i>	block of flats	<i>apartment</i>

Japanese *wasei-eigo* “English made in Japan”, and Konglish

The Traffic Runs Both Ways

English	from	
<i>tycoon</i>	Japanese 大君 <i>taikun</i>	great lord
<i>ketchup</i>	Hokkien <i>kê-tsiap</i> (via Malay)	fish brine
<i>emoji</i>	Japanese 絵文字 <i>emoji</i>	picture character
<i>amok</i>	Malay <i>amuk</i>	
<i>orangutan</i>	Malay <i>orang hutan</i>	forest person

emoji has nothing to do with *emotion*

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Three Ways to Build a Word

affixation	<i>un-reli-able, sad-ness, re-written</i>
compounding	<i>book-shop, black-board</i>
reduplication	<i>choo-choo</i>

- **Derivation** makes new words; **inflection** changes a word's form for grammar (tense, number)
- Sinitic and mainland Southeast Asian languages have almost no inflection; Japanese, Korean and Austronesian do
- Derivation is more common than inflection in many Asian languages

Compounding: The Main Way to Make Words

- Sinitic and mainland Southeast Asian languages rely on it
- Usually **two** elements: nouns, adjectives or verbs
- Productive, but the meaning is not always predictable

Mandarin Compounds

		literally	means
parallel	花木 <i>huā-mù</i>	flower-tree	vegetation
metaphor	狗熊 <i>gǒu-xióng</i>	dog-bear	bear
verb/adj.	痛苦 <i>tòng-kǔ</i>	painful-bitter	suffering
N ₁ N ₂	台灯 <i>tái-dēng</i>	table-lamp	desk lamp

Productive N₁ N₂ patterns: N₁ is the place, purpose or material of N₂

Japanese Compounds: Native, Sino-Japanese, Foreign

		literally	means
native	<i>aki-zora</i>	autumn-sky	autumn sky
S-J	<i>to-kei</i>	time-meter	clock
S-J	<i>shakai-gaku</i>	society-study	sociology
hybrid	<i>keshi-gomu</i>	erase-rubber	eraser

Compounding is the most productive way to make words in Japanese;
Sino-Japanese compounds dominate technical vocabulary

Rendaku: The Second Part Voices

aki + *sora* → *aki-zora* autumn sky

hito + *hito* → *hito-bito* people

te + *kami* → *te-gami* letter

Native compounds often voice the first consonant of the second element

Japanese Compound Verbs

	literally	means
<i>naguri-korosu</i>	beat-kill	kill by beating (manner)
<i>kaki-ageru</i>	write-raise	write up (aspect)

Native and Sino-Japanese compounds order their parts differently: native OV *hon-yomi* “book-reading”, Sino-Japanese VO *doku-sho* “read-book”

The Action Can Name the Doer or the Tool

	literally	the action	also
<i>hito-goroshi</i>	person-kill	killing a person	a killer
<i>ha-migaki</i>	tooth-polish	brushing teeth	toothpaste

Compound meanings shift from action to agent, instrument or location

Japanese Loves Abbreviations

paasonaru konpyutaa → *paso-kon*

tōkyō daigaku → *tō-dai*

大阪大学 *ōsaka daigaku* → 阪大 *han-dai* not 大大!

- Long compounds are clipped to a preferred length
- Blends merge parts of different words
- Everywhere in the media and everyday speech

Reduplication: Say It Twice

Vietnamese	<i>đỏ</i> red	→	<i>đỏ đỏ</i> reddish
	<i>trắng</i> white	→	<i>trắng trắng</i> whitish
Indonesian	<i>lalat</i> fly	→	<i>lalat-lalat</i> flies

- Far more common in East and Southeast Asia than in English
- Attenuation, intensity, plurality; often partial, often with a sound change — here the reduplicant loses its tone

Rhyming and Chiming

	Indonesian		English
rhyming	<i>kaya-raya</i>	rich	<i>lovey-dovey</i>
chiming	<i>teka-teki</i>	riddle	<i>zig-zag</i>
	<i>bolak-balik</i>	back and forth	<i>flip-flop</i>

Often idiomatic and expressive; extensive in Thai and Vietnamese too

Few Affixes in Sinitic and Mainland Southeast Asia

Cantonese	<i>góng-faat</i>	speak-way	way of saying
	<i>yihndoih-fa</i>	modern-ize	modernize
Thai	<i>kaan-lên</i>	NMLZ-play	playing
Vietnamese	<i>phản-kháng</i>	counter-resist	protest

- Many Vietnamese affixes are Chinese (*phản-* < 反); productive in journalism and academic writing
- Hakka marks gender with suffixes derived from kin terms

Malay: Rich, Productive Affixation

root		derived	
<i>darat</i>	land	<i>meN-</i> <i>men-darat</i>	go ashore
<i>bersih</i>	clean	<i>meN-</i> <i>-kan</i> <i>mem-bersih-kan</i>	to clean

Prefixes, suffixes and circumfixes: *meN-* makes dynamic verbs, *-kan* makes transitive ones

Korean and Japanese: Causative Suffixes

Korean	<i>bo-</i> see	<i>bo-i-</i>	show
Japanese	<i>mi-</i> see	<i>mi-sase-</i>	make someone look

Korean *-i* has several allomorphs; Japanese *-(s)ase* attaches to almost any verb

Summary: Who Uses Which Tool?

	compound	reduplicate	affix
Mandarin, Cantonese	●	◐	○
Thai, Vietnamese	●	●	◐
Japanese	●	◐	●
Korean	◐	◐	●
Malay, Indonesian	◐	●	●

Isolating languages compound; Austronesian, Japanese and Korean affix

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Some Words Have No Equivalent

お見合い	<i>omiai</i>	formal marriage meeting
酒	<i>sake</i>	any alcoholic drink
日本酒	<i>nihonshu</i>	“Japanese sake” — the rice wine

- English borrowed *sake* for the rice wine, but in Japanese it has broadened to all alcohol
- Words for emotions, values and ideals differ too — and so do basic words

Describing Meaning: Polysemy

How can we describe it when we don't have it in our language?

- Define with **simpler** words, never circular or obscure ones
- **Polysemy**: one word, several related meanings
- Languages **group** meanings differently — so compare the meanings, not just the words

Languages Carve Up Meanings Differently

English	Czech	Malay	Japanese	Mandarin	
<i>nose</i>	<i>nos</i>	<i>hidung</i>		<i>bízi</i>	of a person
<i>trunk</i>	<i>chobot</i>	<i>belalai</i>	<i>hana</i>		of an elephant
<i>muzzle</i>	<i>čenich</i>	<i>muncung</i>		<i>zuǐ</i>	of a dog
<i>beak</i>	<i>zobák</i>	<i>paruh</i>	<i>kuchibashi</i>		of a bird

English	Malay	
<i>live</i>	<i>hidup</i>	be alive
	<i>tinggal</i>	reside somewhere

The Syntax Can be Different

- Each meaning comes with its own **grammatical frame**
- English *live* “reside” needs a place: *live in Prague*
- Malay *buat*: *buat kuih* “make” vs *buat kerja* “do”

Different arguments $\Rightarrow$ different meanings

“Exist (There is)” and “Have”: Often One Word

(1) *Ada dua ekor lembu.*

exist two CLF cow

“There are two cows.” [zsm]

(2) *Orang ini ada dua ekor lembu.*

person this exist two CLF cow

“This person has two cows.” [zsm]

Malay *ada*, Mandarin *yǒu*: one argument means “there is”, two arguments mean “have”

Even Water Differs

English	Japanese	
<i>water</i>	水 <i>mizu</i>	cold or room temperature
	湯 <i>yu</i>	hot

atsui mizu “hot *mizu*” sounds odd: Japanese does not have one word for *all* water

How Do Things Break?

Malay

putus break in two
patah break, not sever
pecah break into pieces

Japanese

oru break off
kowasu destroy
kiru cut off

Cantonese also distinguishes how something breaks: *dá laahn* “smash into pieces”

But is English so different? *destroy*, *cut*, *cut off*, *cut out*, *cut through*, *sever*, ...

Coming and Going

- English *come* moves towards the speaker *or* the addressee
- Japanese *kuru*, Malay *datang* and Korean *oda* cannot shift the viewpoint that way

English *I'm coming!*

Japanese *Ima iki-masu!* “now go”

How Many Words for Rice?

How Many Words for Rice?

	English	Malay	Japanese	Cantonese
growing		<i>padi</i>	稻 <i>ine</i>	禾 <i>wòh</i>
raw	<i>rice</i>	<i>beras</i>	米 <i>kome</i>	米 <i>máih</i>
cooked		<i>nasi</i>	ご飯 <i>gohan</i>	飯 <i>faahn</i>

How Many Words for Rice?

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cooked		<i>nasi</i>	ご飯 <i>gohan</i>	飯 <i>faahn</i>

Cooked rice often means “a meal”: Japanese *gohan*, Cantonese *sihk faahn* “eat rice” “eat a meal”

Older and Younger Siblings

	English	Thai	Mandarin
older brother	<i>brother</i>	<i>phîi</i>	<i>gēge</i>
older sister	<i>sister</i>		<i>jiějie</i>
younger brother	<i>brother</i>	<i>nóu</i>	<i>dìdi</i>
younger sister	<i>sister</i>		<i>mèimei</i>

Relative age sets lifelong seniority in many Asian families

Birth Order in the Name

- Mandarin: “first brother”, “second brother”, ...
- Malay family nicknames: *long* “oldest”, ..., *teh* “fourth”

Kin terms encode family roles, hierarchy and lineage

Feelings Live in the Body: Psycho-Collocations

	literally	means
Malay <i>panas hati</i>	hot liver	angry, worked up
Thai <i>thùuk-cay</i>	correct heart	please, satisfy
Lai <i>thin haaN</i>	liver become liquid	angry
English <i>hot-headed</i>	hot head	quick to anger

A body-part noun + adjective or verb (Matisoff, 1986); Thai, Malay and Lai have dozens — an **areal** feature of mainland Southeast Asia

Words for Nature and Seasons

- Rich vocabularies for weather, plants, insects and fish reflect traditional ways of life
- Japanese poetry has a whole class of **season words** (季語 *kigo*):

五月雨	<i>samidare</i>	early-summer rain
小春日和	<i>koharubiyori</i>	mild day in late autumn

Summary: Meaning Differs, Even for Basic Words

- Some words have **no equivalent**
- Even basic words **split or merge** meanings differently
- Kinship, rice and emotion words show what a culture **cares about**

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Cultural Key Words

- Words around which a culture **organizes** a whole domain
- Common, and turn up in proverbs and sayings
- Often have **no equivalent** elsewhere

English *love, honesty*

Australian *mate*

Japanese *omiai*

Describing Them Without Bias

- English glosses smuggle in English concepts (**ethnocentrism**)
- Instead, explain with **semantic primes**: simple meanings found in every language (Wierzbicka, 1996)

SOMEONE THINK GOOD WANT BECAUSE

This **Natural Semantic Metalanguage** (NSM) can be checked against native speakers' intuitions

Malay *malu*

“shame”, “shy”, “embarrassed”

Aku malu. “I’m ashamed.”

Eh! Malu pulak dia! “Oh, now they’re shy!”

Fear that others will think or say something bad about you ⇒ wanting to avoid them; it keeps people in line

Explication: *malu*

X feels *malu*

X feels something bad because X thinks like this:

people can know something about me

people can think something bad about me because of this

people can say something bad about me because of this

I don't want this

because X feels like this, X doesn't want to be near other people

it is good if people can feel something like this

Malay *sabar*

“patience” — but broader: staying calm, enduring without losing control

Bersabar...

“Be patient...”

Sabar, jangan menangis.

“Calm down, don’t cry.”

Allah sentiasa bersama dengan orang-orang yang sabar

“Allah is always with those who are patient”

Explication: *sabar*

X is *sabar* [at the time]

at this time, X felt something bad

because of this, X could have thought:

I don't want this

I want to do something now

X did not think like this, because X didn't want to think like this

it is good if a person can be like this

Sabar takes inner discipline and self-control

Chinese 孝 *xiào*

filial piety: duty, respect and care for parents, alive or dead

百善孝为先 *bǎi shàn xiào wéi xiān*

“Of the hundred good deeds, *xiào* comes first”

父母恩比山高，比海深 *fùmǔ ēn bǐ shān gāo, bǐ hǎi shēn*

“What our parents give us is higher than a mountain,
deeper than the ocean”

Explication: 孝 *xiào* (1)

everyone can think about some other people like this:

this person is my father, this person is my mother

I exist because of them

because of this when I think about them I feel something very good

I cannot think about other people like this

it is good if a person thinks about these people at all times

it is good if this person feels something because of this

Explication: 孝 *xiào* (2)

it is good if a person thinks about these people like this:

I want them to feel something very good at all times
because of this I have to do many good things for them

I want to do these things

I don't want these people to feel anything bad at any time
because of this I cannot do some things

I don't want to do these things

it is good if a person thinks like this about some people

it is good if a person does many things because of this

it is bad if a person doesn't think like this about some people

Chinese 忍 *rěn*

perseverance: enduring hardship without complaint, for a greater goal

忍气吞声 *rěn qì tūn shēng*

“endure one’s anger and swallow one’s voice”

Long-term goals over immediate desires; a source of inner strength

Explication: 忍 *rěn* (1)

everyone can think like this about some things:

I want these things to happen

I know they cannot happen if I don't do some things

I want to do these things because of this

if I have to do these things for a long time I don't want not to do them because of this

if I feel something bad when I do these things I don't want not to do them because of this

Explication: 忍 *rěn* (2)

it is good if a person always thinks like this

it is good if a person thinks about this when this person feels something bad

it is good if a person thinks about this when someone else does something bad to this person

it is good if a person does many things because this person thinks like this

it is good if a person can be like this

Japanese 甘え *amae*

dependence: taking someone's love and care for granted

“When I am with Y, nothing bad can happen to me”

Modelled on an infant's dependence on its mother; part of all close relationships in Japan

Explication: 甘え *amae*

X feels *amae* towards Y

X thinks like this about Y:

when Y thinks about me, Y feels something good

Y wants to do good things for me

Y can do good things for me

when I am with Y nothing bad can happen to me

I don't have to do anything because of this

I want to be with Y

X feels something good because of this

Japanese 思い遣り *omoiyari*

empathy: knowing what others need without being told
literally “think-give”

Omoiyari no aru ko ni natte ne.

“Please become a person with *omoiyari*.”

Omoiyari no kokoro o taisetsu ni shimashō.

“Let’s treasure the heart of *omoiyari*.”

Keeps harmony and avoids conflict

Explication: 思い遣り *omoiyari*

X has *omoiyari*

X often thinks like this about other people:

I can know what this person feels

I can know what this person wants

I can do something good for this person because of this

I want to do this

this person doesn't have to say anything

because of this, X does something

people think this is good

Conclusions

- **Loans** map contact history: English, Malay and Japanese are built in layers
- Words are built by **compounding**, **reduplication** and **affixation**, in different mixes
- Languages **carve up meaning** differently, even for water, rice and siblings
- **Cultural key words** can be explained without bias in semantic primes

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